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# Public Speaking

## Lecture 51 : Effective Use of Language in Public Speaking

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DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES



“Language is power, life and the instrument of culture, the instrument of domination and liberation.”

- Angela Carter



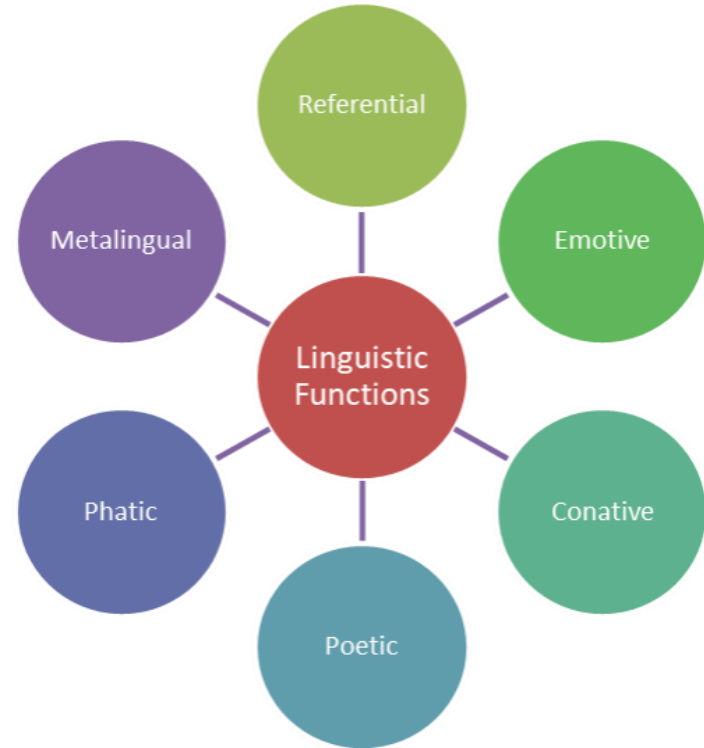
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# Introduction

- ❖ Language is one of the most important constructions of human society.
- ❖ Edward Sapir and Benjamin Lee Whorf propounded the linguistic relativity hypothesis.
- ❖ According to the Sapir-Whorf Hypothesis, “the particular language one speaks influences the way one thinks about reality.”
- ❖ It helps us to understand the powerful role of language in constructing human perceptions and understanding one’s world.

# Functions of Language

- ❑ Russian Linguist Roman Jakobson states that there are six functions of language.
- ❑ Each function has its purpose of achieving and establishing a communicative act between the addresser and addressee.



# Functions of Language

1. **Referential:** Objective use of language. Information transfer.
2. **Conative:** Calls for attention. Receiver-oriented.
3. **Emotive:** Deals with emotion and suggests the tone of speech.
4. **Phatic:** Establishes social connection.
5. **Poetic:** Aesthetic and rhetorically oriented.
6. **Metalingual:** Discusses the language in itself - its function, meaning, features, ambiguity etc.



# Oral and Written Language

| Oral Language                        | Written Language                   |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Employs conciseness.                 | Pays attention to detail.          |
| Few syllable words are chosen.       | Word syllables range vary.         |
| Short sentences are preferred.       | Large sentences are also accepted. |
| First-person pronouns.               | Third-person pronouns.             |
| Flexibility with formality and tone. | Standard and concrete.             |

# Six C's of Language Use

❑ Michael Osborn et al. (1988), in their book entitled *Public Speaking: Finding Your Voice*, jot down six key elements of language:

- ❖ Clarity
- ❖ Color
- ❖ Concreteness
- ❖ Correctness
- ❖ Conciseness
- ❖ Cultural Sensitivity

# Clarity of Thoughts and Words

## □ Clarity:

- a. Clarity comes as the essential element and posits itself as the first standard to be met when it comes to public speaking.
- b. One must have clarity of one's own thoughts in order to express clarity in their words.
- c. Finding the most suitable words helps the speaker in achieving clarity.
- d. The element of clarity is essential for an understanding to develop between the addresser and the addressee.



# Factors Impairing Clarity

1. **Jargon:** Technical language that creates distance between speaker and receiver who are not acquainted with the vocabulary.
2. **Euphemism:** Although it relieves the tension of speech when talking about delicate issues, at times, it may obscure the truth and intention.
3. **Doublespeak:** The prodigy of two Orwellian terms, namely “doublethink” and “newspeak”, signifies the conscious distortion of language.



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## Connection between Language and Thought

“A man may take to drink because he feels himself to be a failure, and then fail all the more completely because he drinks. It is rather the same thing that is happening to the English language. It becomes ugly and inaccurate because our thoughts are foolish, but the slovenliness of our language makes it easier for us to have foolish thoughts.” (George Orwell)



# Color of Language

- Color here refers particularly to the tone and vibrancy of language used, and not in contextual terms relating to race or ethnicity.
- It employs rich imagery and creative neologism that captures the attention of the listeners.
- Slang, which one should refrain from using in formal scenarios, embodies the colour of common reality. As a general semanticist, S.I. Hayakawa connotes slang as “the poetry of everyday life.”

# Choosing Conciseness

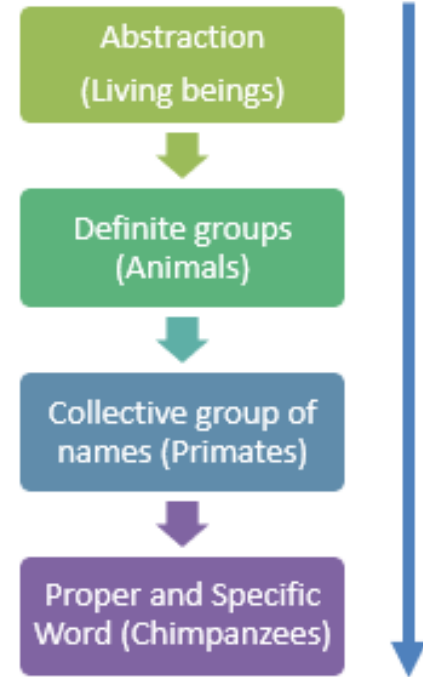
- ❑ Clarity of thoughts enables conciseness in itself.
- ❑ The quote offered by Thomas Jefferson sums up the value of conciseness, “The most valuable of all talents is that of never using two words when one will do.”
- ❑ Verbosity and Pompousness can be replaced with the usage of effective maxims.
- ❑ However, amplification, i.e., explanation of words, becomes necessary.

# Constructing Concrete Language

1. Orality faces the challenge of being concise yet effective enough to satisfy all the listener's understanding and attention requirements.
2. Concreteness of words chosen helps to solve the problem of oral communication.
3. Pictorial and precise information helps to counter the ambiguity of abstractions.
4. S.I. Hayakawa coined the “ladder of abstraction” to evaluate how humans communicate and think in varying degrees.

# Ladder of Abstraction

- ❑ As an effective public speaker, one must not stick only to the top or the bottom of the ladder, which shall result in misunderstanding and gaps.
- ❑ As prominent writing coach Roy Peter Clark mentions, a public speaker “must climb up and down the ladder of abstraction” throughout the speech.



# Correctness and Cultural Sensitivity

## 5. Correctness:

- ❖ Grammatical and lexical correctness becomes integral for a public speaker to maintain their credibility.
- ❖ Avoid Malapropisms, i.e., making language errors by using words of similar sounds interchangeably.

## 6. Cultural Sensitivity:

- Apart from grammar, conscious and sensitive word choice concerning the cultural group of listeners also reflects the talent of a public speaker.

# Some Cautions

- ❖ Make use of simple and natural language.
- ❖ Ensure to talk with the audience, not to them, not at them.
- ❖ Use personal references.
- ❖ Prefer active to passive verbs.
- ❖ Concrete and not generalities.
- ❖ Avoid using jargon unless speaking to your professional group.

Different from/different from  
Further/farther  
Imply/infer  
Lie/lay  
Prescribe/proscribe



## Make Use of Small Words

“We shall not flag nor fail. We shall go on to the end. We shall fight in France and on the seas and oceans; we shall fight with growing confidence and growing strength in the air. We shall defend our island whatever the cost may be; we shall fight on beaches, landing grounds, in fields, in streets and on the hills. We shall never surrender, and even if, which I do not for the moment believe, this island or a large part of it were subjugated and starving, then our empire beyond the seas, armed and guarded by the British Fleet, will carry on the struggle until in God's good time the New World with all its power and might, sets forth to the liberation and rescue of the Old.” (Winston Churchill)

# Strong Emotional Appeal

“The shadows are lengthening for me. The twilight is here. My days of old have vanished, tone and tint. They have gone glimmering through the dreams of things that were. Their memory is one of wondrous beauty, watered by tears, and coaxed and caressed by the smiles of yesterday. I listen vainly, but with thirsty ears, for the witching melody of faint bugles blowing reveille, of far drums beating the long roll. In my dreams I hear again the crash of guns, the rattle of musketry, the strange, mournful mutter of the battlefield.”

( General Douglas MacArthur, in his farewell to Corps of Cadet in 1962)



“The difference between the right word and the almost right word is the difference between fire and a firefly”.  
--Mark Twain

**Thank You**

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# Public Speaking

## Lecture 52 - Handling Feedback and Criticism

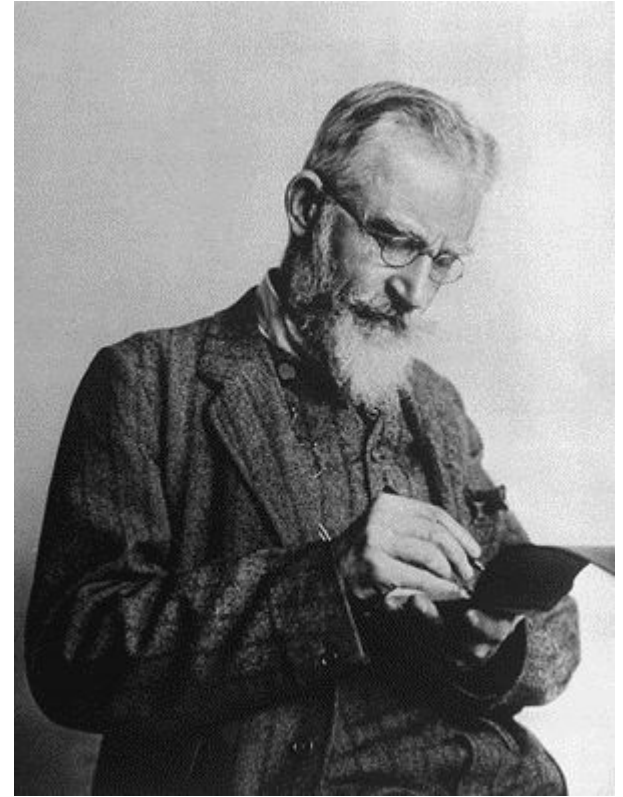
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“A life spent making mistakes is not only more honourable but more useful than a life spent doing nothing.”

-George Bernard Shaw.



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# Introduction

- ❖ Criticism refers to one's expression of judgment about:
  - an individual,
  - an event or
  - an object of review.
- ❖ Under close scrutiny, anything/anyone shall beget criticism ranging from **positive** to **negative**.
- ❖ In public speaking, it is not only the speaker who shall offer criticism through speech, but one should simultaneously be ready to receive criticism and feedback as well.



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# Understanding Criticism

- ❑ Criticism is generally understood as a negative reaction, disapproval or a mark of rejection.
- ❑ However, in written and oral discourse, it can mean the investigation of the subject matter to discuss subsequent merits and demerits.
- ❑ Apart from criticism expressed through public speaking, public speakers receive criticism depending upon their:
  - ❖ Skills (verbal and non-verbal)
  - ❖ Content (message, idea and argument)



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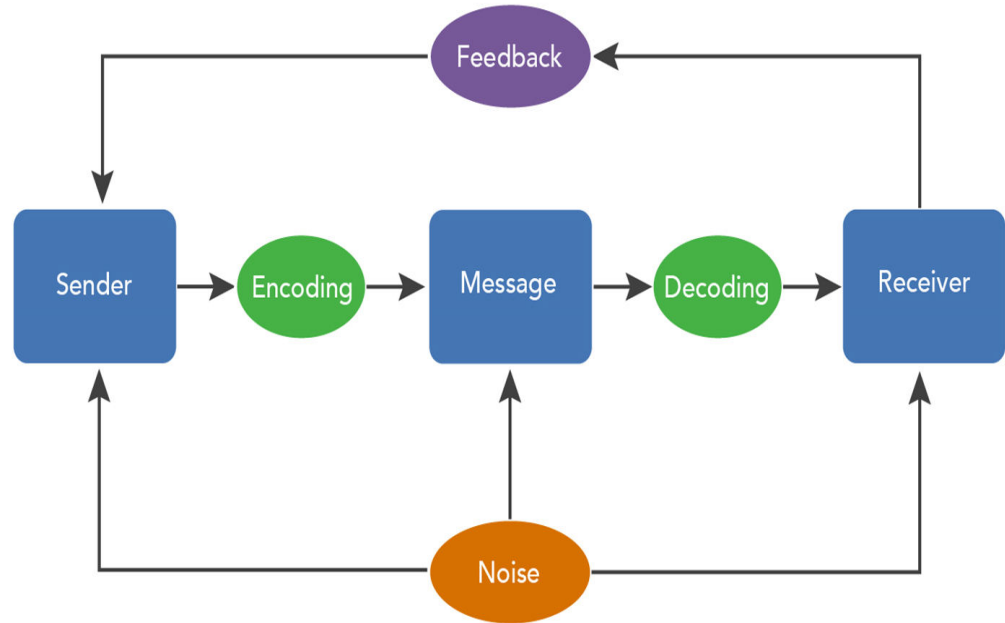
# Understanding Feedback

- ❑ Feedback has a more positive connotation attached to itself as compared to criticism.
- ❑ It is usually a part of the task/performance assessment report which suggests areas requiring improvement.
- ❑ In public speaking, feedback is offered by audience members who listen to evaluate the speaker's delivery.
- ❑ Audience may offer direct feedback (**verbally**) or even indirect feedback (**non-verbal signs**).



# Feedback in Communication

- ❖ A communicative act is not unidirectional in nature.
- ❖ A speaker shall also receive feedback responses from the audience.
- ❖ Feedback helps the sender to understand if s/he is misunderstood or ineffective.
- ❖ A speaker may then clarify themselves better and develop their strategy.



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# Differences Between Criticism and Feedback

| Criticism                                                  | Feedback                                        |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| ➤ Criticism solely points out the demerits of the speaker. | ➤ Feedback focuses on the areas to be improved. |
| ➤ Mostly discouraging and harsh in tone                    | ➤ Supportive and suggestive                     |
| ➤ Problem- oriented                                        | ➤ Solution Oriented                             |
| ➤ Past-oriented                                            | ➤ Future-oriented                               |

# Importance of Criticism and Feedback

- ❖ Gaining feedback and criticism could be the most useful and inexpensive way to help oneself become a better public speaker.
- ❖ One needs a good and attentive audience to expect relevant feedback and criticism.
- ❖ A sound criticism implies that the audience listened to the speaker carefully.
- ❖ It can serve as a great resource to evaluate the effectiveness of one's speech or presentation.

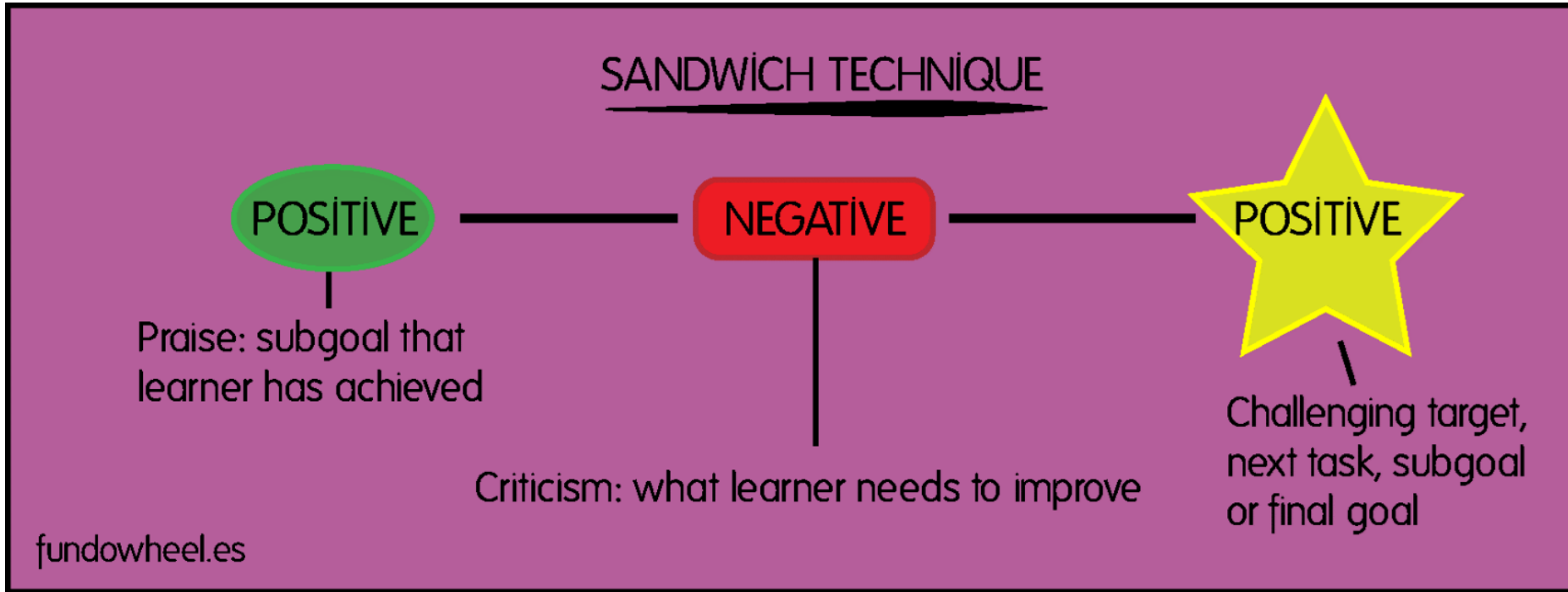
# Approaching Constructive Criticism and Feedback

- ❑ Combating common areas of criticism:
  - Be loud and express confidence through your voice. (Paralanguage)
  - Stick to your main message. Avoid too much digression. (Content)
  - Connect better with the audience through eye contact. (Kinesics)
- ❑ Understanding how your message is received on the other end:
  - Try to eliminate the negatives to increase your potential as a public speaker.
  - Approach the suggestions with an open attitude and growth mindset.

# Types of Criticism

| Constructive Criticism                                                                                                                                                          | Destructive Criticism                                                                                                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▪ Offers an objective analysis without any personal bias</li><li>▪ It is a feedback method that offers positive recommendations</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▪ Disapproving and biased in nature</li><li>▪ Does not offer any recommendations</li></ul> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▪ Specific and Clear</li></ul>                                                                                                            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▪ Vague and Ambiguous</li></ul>                                                            |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▪ Motivates the speaker to improve further</li></ul>                                                                                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▪ Demotivates and puts speaker in distress</li></ul>                                       |

# Components of Effective Criticism



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# Types of Feedback

## Positive Feedback

- Too much appreciative
- Fails to offer suggestions

## Negative Feedback

- Creates conflict
- Directs anxiety and stress

## Corrective Feedback

- Explains errors that occurred.
- Refers to the areas for improvement.

## Motivating Feedback

- Reinforces support



# How to Gather Feedback?

- ✓ Perceive non-verbal cues as live feedback from the audience during the session.
- ✓ Prompting the audience to ask questions, raise doubts and seek clarity.
- ✓ Circulating feedback forms after the event.
- ✓ Providing email-id to communicate and interact further about the topic discussed.



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# Self-Criticism

- ❑ Self-criticism is a psychological tendency to self-evaluate oneself negatively. It may result in the feelings such as:
  - Worthlessness
  - Failure
  - Guilt
  - Anxiety
  - Depression
- ❑ It hampers one's self-esteem and may sabotage one's opportunity in the public speaking arena.
- ❑ Excessive perfectionism drives toxic self-criticism.
- ❑ A public speaker must strive to be emotionally intelligent and mature to overcome such tendencies.



“He is his own harshest critic”

# Rational-emotive Behaviour Therapy

- ❖ Proposed by Dr Albert Ellis in 1955.
- ❖ Either low or high self-esteem can be unhealthy because any level of self-esteem reflects the occurrence of a dysfunctional self-rating process, an evaluation of one's global worth.
- ❖ Our thinking about events leads to emotional and behavioural upset.
- ❖ USA (Unconditional Self-Acceptance)
- ❖ Those scoring higher in the USA tend to be lower in depression proneness and more objective in their evaluations of their speech performances



# Role of Emotional Intelligence

- ❑ Emotional Intelligence (EI) is the key to handling any kind of criticism and feedback, be it positive or negative.
- ❑ Here are a few tips to utilize E.I. while handling criticism:
  - Pause and listen. Let the other person finish.
  - De-personalize the message
  - Take away the positive insights.
  - Appreciate the critic for their time, attention and suggestions



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With EI, one can also be one's own best critic!

# Make effective use of persuasion.

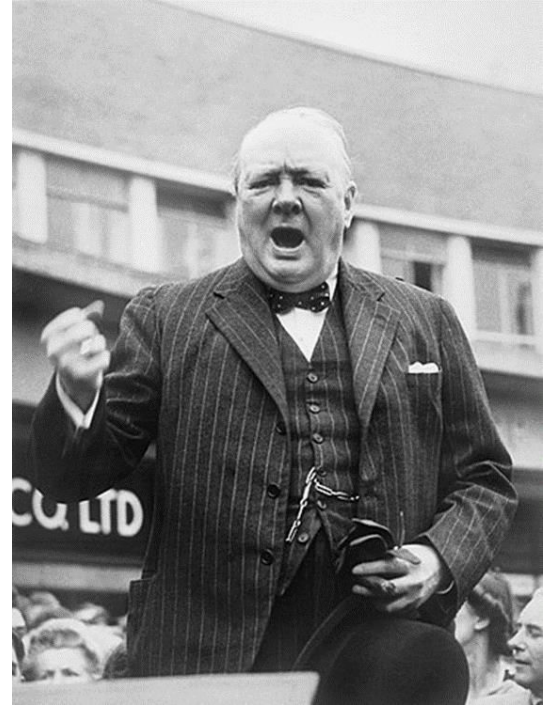
- ❑ Christopher Turk, in his book *Effective Speaking*, suggests seven levers of persuasion:
  - ❖ Self-preservation
  - ❖ Possession
  - ❖ Power
  - ❖ Posterity
  - ❖ Convention
  - ❖ Sentiment
  - ❖ Contrary suggestion



“Criticism may not be agreeable,  
but it is necessary. It fulfils the  
same function as pain in the human  
body. It calls attention to an  
unhealthy state of things.”

-Winston Churchill

**Thank You**



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# Public Speaking

## Lecture 53 - Role of Creative Thinking

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DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES





“You can’t use up creativity.  
The more you use, the more  
you have.”  
-Maya Angelou

# Creativity



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# Creative Thinking

- If creativity is the ability to create something novel, creative thinking implies the novelty of thoughts and ideas.
- Creative thinking offers a different perspective toward an issue or a debate.
- Creative thinking becomes integral to being successful in writing and speaking domains.
- Creative Thinking has two main components to satisfy:
  - **Originality:** The ideas generated should be the first of their kind.
  - **Functionality:** It should be applicable and should show degrees of usefulness.

# Critical and Creative Thinking

| Creative Thinking                               | Critical Thinking                                                     |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Divergent                                       | Convergent                                                            |
| Employed to create something new and original.  | Employed to assess, evaluate and solve something that already exists. |
| Usually defies accepted principles and systems. | Mostly adds on and applies to the established setup.                  |

“Although creative and critical thinking may very well be different sides of the same coin, they are not identical.” - Barry Beyer

# Public Speaking and Creativity

- A creative mind begets a creative speech which garners the audience's time and attention.
- Innovative openings.
  - For example, Swami Vivekananda began his 1893 Chicago speech with the greetings to “Sisters and Brothers of America.”
- Humorizing the audience. (Thinking outside the box)
- Delivering relatable speeches for the audience to connect easily. (Active interpersonal communication)

# Requisites for Creative Thinking

Hungarian-American psychologist Mihaly Csikszentmihalyi in his phenomenal work entitled *Creativity: Flow and the Psychology of Discovery and Invention*, writes three main criteria as essential for creative thinking to occur, they are:

- **Energy:**

A highly active individual is exhibiting energetic physical and mental state.

- **Intelligence:**

Intellect is necessary; however, it should not restrict one's perspectives.

- **Discipline:**

Self-motivated and equally enthusiastic towards work and life events.

# Creativity and Big Five

McCrae and Costa had devised a five-factor theory for grouping global population in accordance to five major personality traits.

1. Extraversion
2. Agreeableness
3. Conscientiousness
4. Openness
5. Neuroticism

Out of the five traits, **openness to experience** gains the highest correlation with creative thinking.



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# Convergent and Divergent Thinking

| Convergent Thinking                                  | Divergent Thinking                         |
|------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| 1. Attempts to find the most effective solution.     | 1. Provides multiple creative solutions.   |
| 2. Deductive in nature                               | 2. Inductive                               |
| 3. Logical and Linear                                | 3. Spontaneous and Multi-linear            |
| 4. Goes well with agreeable personality trait groups | 4. Opted by open-minded personalities      |
| 5. Purely realistic                                  | 6. Imaginative yet seeks practical outcome |

\*Creative minds employ divergent thinking.



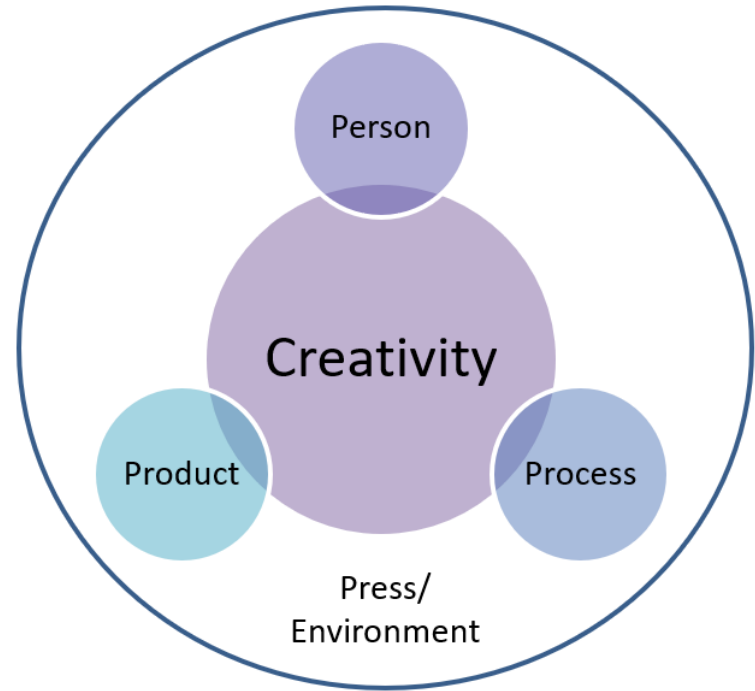
# Types of Creative Thinking

- ❑ Dr. James C. Kaufman and Dr. Ronald Beghetto identified *Four-c model* of creativity based on the impact level of creative thinking.
  1. “Mini-c” creativity:
    - a. Personal creative thoughts restricted only to a particular individual’s lifestyle.
  2. “Little-c” creativity:
    - a. Creative thinking which solves everyday problems and adapts to changes.
  3. “Pro-C” creativity:
    - a. Professional level creativity that increases work efficiency.
  4. “Big-C” creativity:
    - a. Ideas that leads to a revolutionary change in the concerned area.



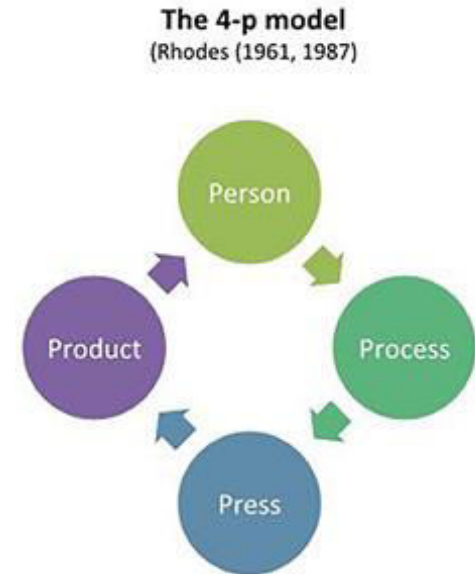
# Four-P Model of Creativity

- When creative thinking meets functionality, it results in growth, convenience and comfort for the parties involved.
- The “4-P’s of Creativity” model generated by Mel Rhodes in his article *The Analysis of Creative Thinking* (1961) elucidates upon how a creative mind can be developed and employed in different fields.



# Four-P Model of Creativity

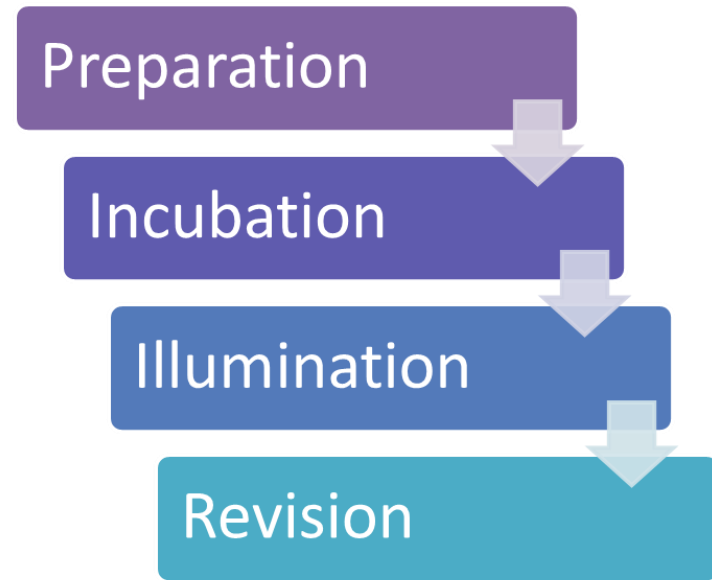
- **Person:**  
Individual traits, habits and attitudes.
- **Process:**  
Applied research and experimentation.
- **Product:**  
Construction of a final creative output i.e., useful and original.
- **Press:**  
Creativity in relation to the external conditions of culture, codes and principles.



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# Four Stages of Creative Thinking

- British Psychologist Graham Wallas in his book *The Art of Thought* (1926) deduced a four-stage model to understand creative process.
- Stage 1 and 4 deals with concrete processes such as collecting and evaluating resources. (conscious level)
- Meanwhile, the intermediate stages of creative thinking deals with abstract level thinking, imagination and inspiration. (unconscious level)



# Four Stages of Creative Thinking

- Stage 1 - Preparation:
  - Collecting information and knowledge to gain base for further creative development.
- Stage 2 - Incubation:
  - Combining and connecting different ideas with the resources at hand.
- Stage 3 - Illumination:
  - Revelations of brilliant ideas. Eureka moment!
- Stage 4 - Revision:
  - Verification of the whole process and idea generated.

# Lateral thinking in Public Speaking

- ❖ The term “lateral thinking” suggests unorthodox and inventive approaches to a given task/situation.
- ❖ It is an approach which a public speaker shall employ to make their delivery more creative and engaging.
- ❖ Lateral thinking is more function-oriented with enough concern towards implementation of ideas and its practicality.
- ❖ The speech which incorporates such thinking challenges assumptions and escapes dominant narrative.
- ❖ Vivid perspectives offered by a speaker shall captivate large number of masses.

When learning is purposeful, creativity blossoms.  
When creativity blossoms, thinking emanates. When  
thinking emanates, knowledge is fully lit. When  
knowledge is lit, the economy flourishes.

-A.P.J. Abdul Kalam

**Thank You**

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# Public Speaking

## Lecture 54: Some Other Forums of Public Speaking

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# Popular Forums for Discussion

1. **CONFERENCE**: A platform to confer with people on a topic (of a wider spectrum than seminar or symposium) and to collaborate on their experiences and opinions.
2. **SYMPOSIUM**: A group of knowledgeable participants examine different aspects of a problem, ensued by an open discussion. Ideal for reviewing multiple types of research on a common theme.
3. **CONVENTION**: A fellowship get-together of a close-knit fraternal group, for instance, professional gatherings of companies or political parties.
4. **SEMINAR**: A discussion in a small group where a paper presenter reports their findings, followed by a detailed discussion.
5. **PANEL DISCUSSION**: A process of cooperative thinking enabling a direct exchange of ideas on a topic by a group of experts.

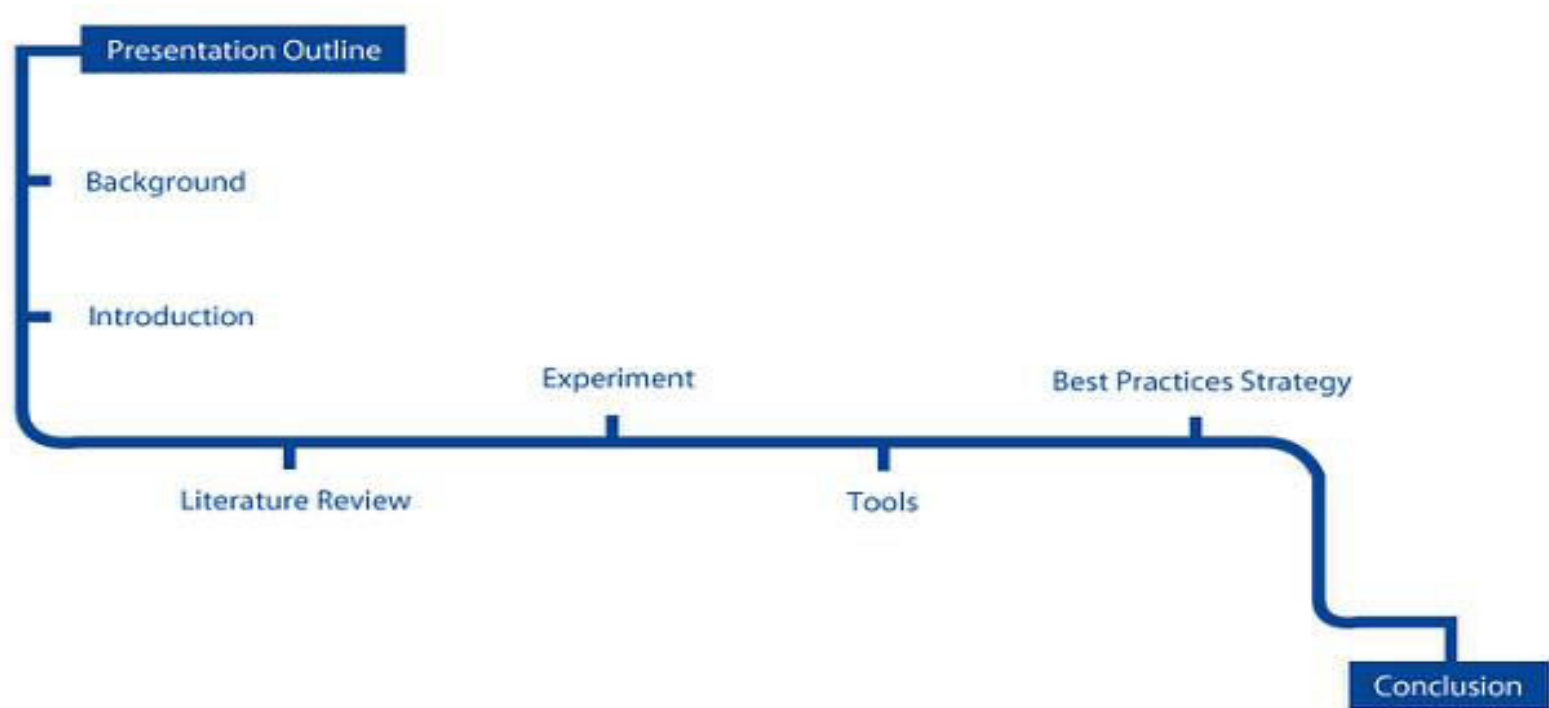


# Seminar

- ❑ A seminar may be defined as a small gathering of people who come to interact together to discuss the delineated topic.
- ❑ It is a mode of group communication, usually academic in nature.
- ❑ Oral as well as written presentations are made.
- ❑ The sessions are followed by question and answer sessions.
- ❑ It is a mixture of speech and group discussion.
- ❑ It always has a chairperson.



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# Significance of Seminar

- ❑ A seminar is operational in fetching the experts' experiences and views on a particular subject matter.
- ❑ It includes meaningful discussions on the existing literature, data and presented papers, their summaries and recommendations.
- ❑ It is an effective method of oral communication.
- ❑ The presenter has the responsibility of carefully articulating the intended subject matter.

# Organizer's Role

For a seminar to be effective and successful, organisers must

- ❖ Decide the date, venue and theme beforehand.
- ❖ Publish required and relevant materials.
- ❖ Promote the seminar in well advance.
- ❖ Ensure the arrangement of aids and gadgets beforehand.
- ❖ Arrange basic courtesies and hospitality.

# Speaker's Role

- ❖ The speaker should present bring something relevant and innovative.
- ❖ Materials should be borrowed from multiple sources- libraries, websites, pdfs, etc.
- ❖ The presentation should be informative, coherent and in logical order.
- ❖ The use of PowerPoint presentations is helpful for maintaining the interest of the audience. However, everything that is supposed to be spoken should not be written in the slides.
- ❖ Time constraints should be followed.
- ❖ Questions should be handled with ease and efficiency without backlashing at anyone.
- ❖ The presentation is for the audience so they should be thanked for their co-operation.

# Chairperson's Role

- ❖ Chairperson plays an important role during the seminar.
- ❖ S/he introduces the topic of discussion briefly.
- ❖ S/he introduces the speakers of the session before their presentation and briefs the audience about their specialisations and achievements.
- ❖ Chairperson has the responsibility of making sure that the presenters wind up in the allotted time.
- ❖ S/he is in charge of moderating the question-answer sessions and avoiding undesirable digressions.
- ❖ S/he has to sum up the entire presentation and the supposed takeaways from every presentation.
- ❖ S/he should thank the speakers as well as the audience at the end.

## Audience's Role

- ❖ Audiences should occupy the seats beforehand and not wait to arrive in the nick of time.
- ❖ They should listen to understand and not merely react or counter.
- ❖ They should make a note of important points and citations.
- ❖ Avoid interrupting during the presentation and wait patiently for the question-answer session.
- ❖ The question should be relevant and fall under the area of enquiry.
- ❖ Maintain decorum and stay seated till the concluding remarks.



# Seminars in the 21<sup>st</sup> Century

- ❑ The conventional understanding and setup of seminars are being modified in the 21<sup>st</sup> century. For instance, in Singapore, several learning centres and educational institutes have come up with a revised version of a seminar, especially for students.

These are unconventional because:

- They are concerned with the enhancement of students' intellect.
- These promote a flexible teaching process
- These seminars don't follow a specific setting.

# Types of Seminars for Student Interaction and Communication

## Community seminar

- Involves adults with some common purpose
- Organised for people facing difficulty at work
- Improves collaboration between two groups/individuals

## Content Area seminar

- A training seminar with integrated classroom model
- Students can look at their curriculum objectively

## Faculty seminar

- It involves professionals who can share their experiences.
- These are capable of changing education culture and give new learning experience to students.

## School-Wide seminar

- Designed for schools for cultural diversity and promotion
- Seminar leaders may change/modify the questions as per their requirements

# Symposium

- ❑ Symposium (Greek: συμπόσιον symposion or symposio, **from συμπίνειν sympinein, "to drink together"**) was a part of a banquet that took place after the meal when drinking for pleasure was accompanied by music, dancing, recitals, or conversation.
- ❑ A symposium is “a public presentation in which several people present prepared speeches on different aspects of the same topic” (Lucas 408).
- ❑ It consists of a moderator and several speakers.

## Contd...

- ☐ The moderator introduces the topic as well as the speakers.
- ☐ The talks/speeches are followed by a question-answer session.
- ☐ It is used for group report presentations.
- ☐ All the speeches are required to be aptly planned and delivered.
- ☐ Coordination is the key in this kind of presentation.

# Panel Discussion

- ❑ A panel discussion is a structured conversation on a pre-decided topic among several people. It always takes place in front of an audience.
- ❑ Like a symposium, it also has a moderator to introduce the topic as well as the panellists.
- ❑ Once the discussion begins, it is the job of the moderator to interject questions and comments in order to save the discussion from derailing.
- ❑ The panellists should be audible to the audience in order to deliver their intended points of view.
- ❑ Panelists must speak briefly and in an informal manner.

## Contd...

- ☐ It is followed by a question-answer session.
- ☐ Because of its spontaneity, panel discussions are enjoyed by the audience as much as by the panellists.
- ☐ Every panellist should be mindful of not making the entire discussion around themselves.
- ☐ These discussions are meant for the panellists and audience, so only a few voices should not dominate.
- ☐ As an audience, one must ask mindful and related questions and not just be a mere spectator.

Avoid monopolizing.

# Reflecting Thinking Method (Lucas)

Define the problem with clarity and brevity

Analyse the problem to determine the causes

Establish criteria for evaluation solutions

Generate wide range of potential solutions

Select the best solution(s)

# Workshop

- ❑ According to Collins Dictionary, “A workshop is a period of discussion or practical work on a particular subject in which a group of people share their knowledge or experience.”
- ❑ The chief objective of any workshop is to add to the expertise of every participant.



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# When to conduct a workshop?

At the beginning of any new venture

During the initial training of staff or volunteers

For the in-service training and development of staff or volunteers

For the demonstration of a new concept

For the explanation of something to the public

Because of the availability of a knowledgeable presenter

## Contd...

### Benefits:

- ☐ It helps in improving professional skills and qualifications.
- ☐ It instils a sense of co-operation and partnership among the participants.
- ☐ Workshops can be a breeding ground for many innovative ideas.

### Functions:

- ☐ It provides room for enquiry, discussions and problem-solving.
- ☐ It provides training/knowledge to the participants by the experts.

## Contd...

### **Purpose:**

- ☐ It aims at providing the newest trends and indispensable information.
- ☐ It exposes the experts to newer variables in their field of knowledge.
- ☐ The diverse group of participants have a lot to offer and exchange.

### **Duration:**

The duration of a workshop depends on what and how long the organisers have to offer. It can be for one day or more.

## Contd...

- ❑ In order to conduct an effective and successful workshop, one requires to plan and prepare thoroughly on the different aspects of the workshop: the tentative audience, the motif of the workshop, venue, duration, activities, and availability of various equipment.
- ❑ One should also keep in mind **the importance of feedback** in order to cater to the needs of the audience as well as for personal growth.

*There's no use talking  
about the problem  
unless you talk  
about the solution.  
-Betty Williams*

**Thank You**

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# Public Speaking

## Lecture 55: Etiquettes and Mannerisms in Public Speaking

Prof. Binod Mishra

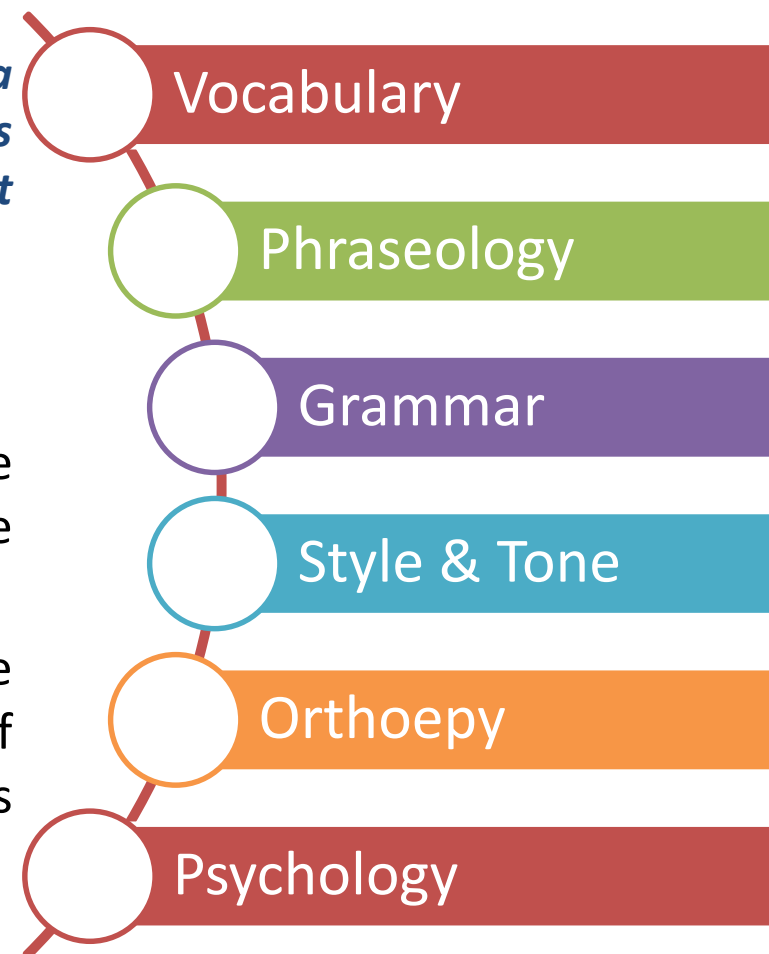
DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES



# Speech Etiquettes

- ✓ According to Cambridge dictionary, etiquette is “the set of rules or customs that control accepted behaviour in particular social groups or social situations.”
- ✓ *“Etiquette is all human social behaviour. If you're a hermit on a mountain, you don't have to worry about etiquette; if somebody comes up the mountain, then you've got a problem. It matters because we want to live in reasonably harmonious communities.” - Judith Martin*
- ❖ Speech etiquette refers to the system of speech behaviour, the rules of live conversation and correspondence, how to use the language and its tools in a specific situation and environment.
- ❖ The study of speech etiquettes is of indispensable importance because it occupies a paramount space at the intersection of linguistics, cultural theory, ethnography and psychology and is crucial in creating an efficient communicative space.

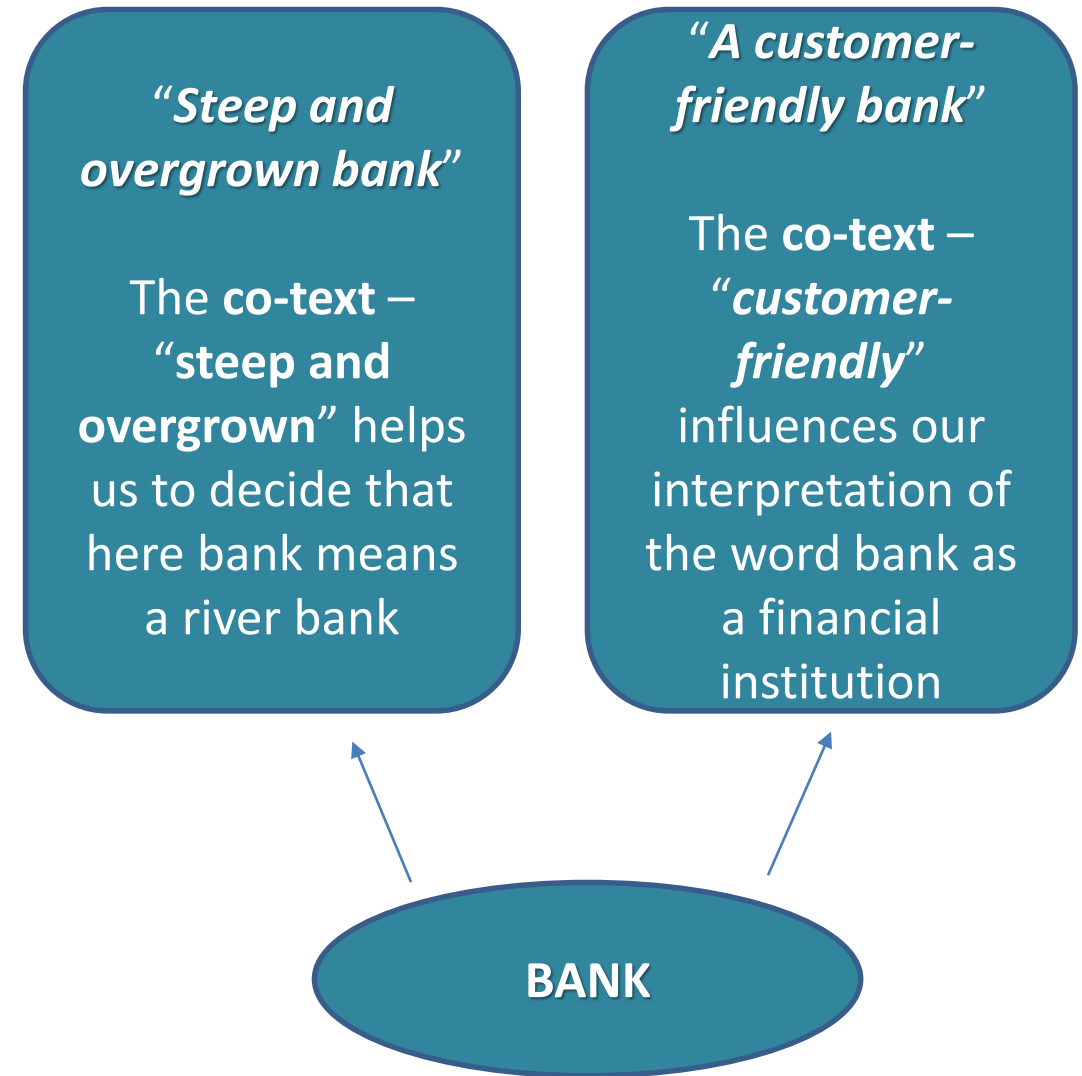
## Levels of Speech Etiquettes





# Pragmatics of Speech: Co-text

- ❑ **George Yule**, in his book, *The Study of Language* (128) states that the **knowledge of pragmatics** is essential in order to create an effective and productive communicative culture.
- ❑ Yule discusses the significance of the **linguistic context**, also termed as **co-text in speech**.
- ❑ Co-text refers to a **word or set of words** used in proximity to the principal word, and **act as a qualifier** to effect what we think the word probably means.
- ❑ Co-texts are of particular importance to clarify the intended meaning in case of **usage of homonyms**.



# Pragmatics of Speech: Use of Deictic Expressions

- ❑ The term '**Deictic Expressions**' comes from the **Greek word 'Deixis'**, which means "**pointing**" via language.
- ❑ Deictic Expressions refer to those bits of language which can be understood or interpreted only when the listener knows the **immediate context (especially the physical context) of the speaker**.
- ❑ Any act of communication involves a **clear and informed use of deictic expressions** in order to drive home the intended message in a non-ambiguous manner.

## Person Deixis

Used to point to a thing or a person

Expressions like – it, these, him, them, those people

E.g. – "The teacher asked John to tell **them** to come tomorrow."

## Spatial Deixis

Words or phrases which point to a location

Expressions like – here, there, near that

E.g. – "Place the box of chocolates **there**."

## Temporal Deixis

Used to point to a time

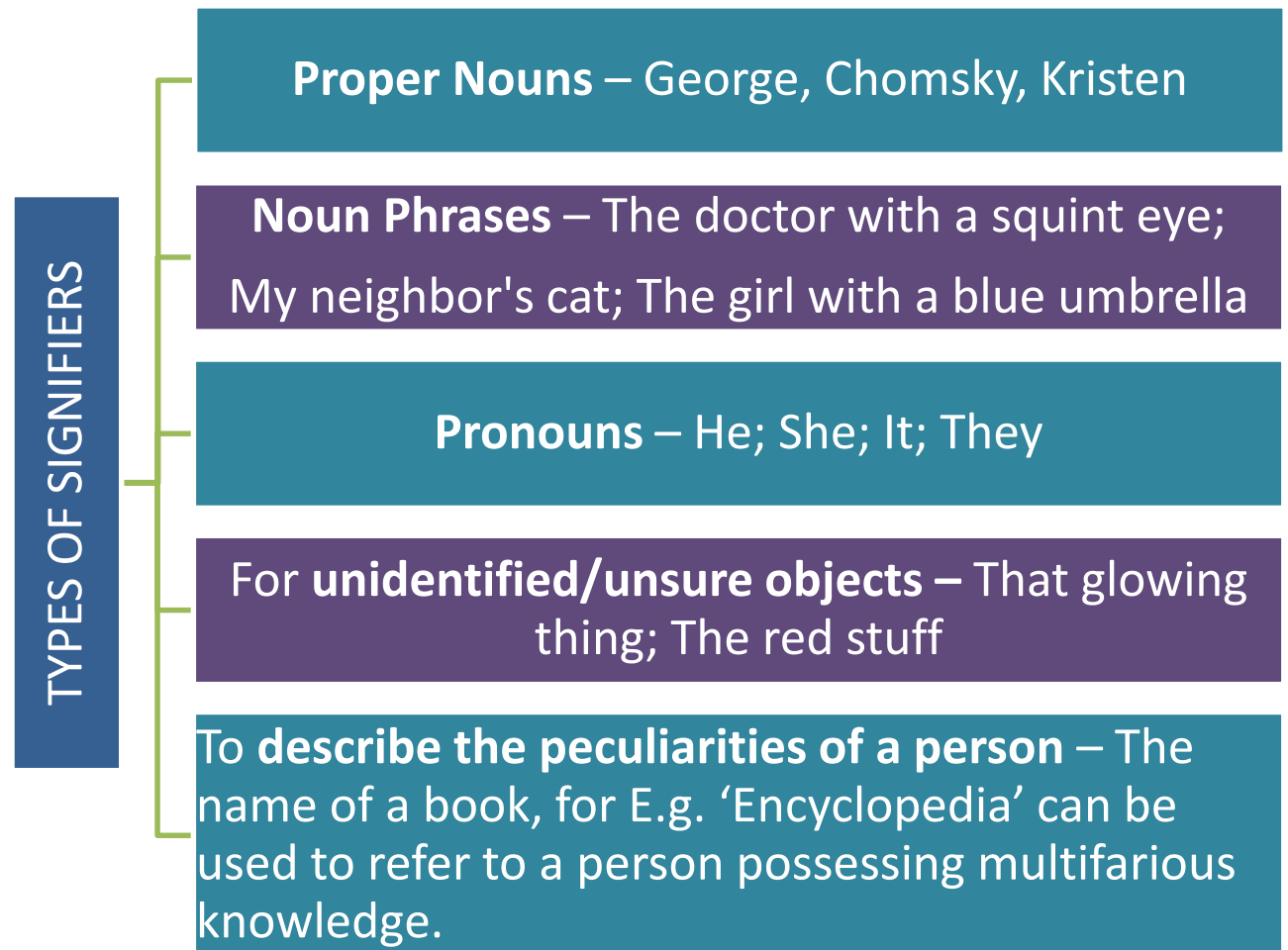
Expressions like – now, then, last week

E.g. – "The convocation is scheduled to take place **next week**."

# Pragmatics of Speech: Reference and Inference

- **George Yule** defines **reference** as *“an act by which a speaker (or writer) uses language to enable a listener (or reader) to identify something.”*
- Words by themselves do not refer anything; people refer.
- **Inference** is the *“additional information (background knowledge, awareness of the context, presence of mind) used by the listener/reader to create a connection between what is said and what must be meant.”* (Yule)
- Successful speech requires a harmonious interplay of reference and inference.

The act of referencing in speech can be carried out by the use of the following **categories of identifiers**:



# Pragmatics of Speech: Pre-supposition

- **“A context is a psychological construct”** (Sperber and Wilson, 1995).
- Pre-supposition is an **assumption by the speaker** about what is **already known by the audience**, while using referencing in his/her talk.
- Speakers tend to **design their linguistic message** on the basis of large-scale assumptions (called as presuppositions) about the **knowledge, awareness and understanding of the audience**.
- **Mistaken pre-suppositions** on the part of the speaker leads to the **failure of communication** of the intended message.
- Thus, the **speaker’s skill of appropriate pre-supposition** is one of the prominent etiquettes of speech.

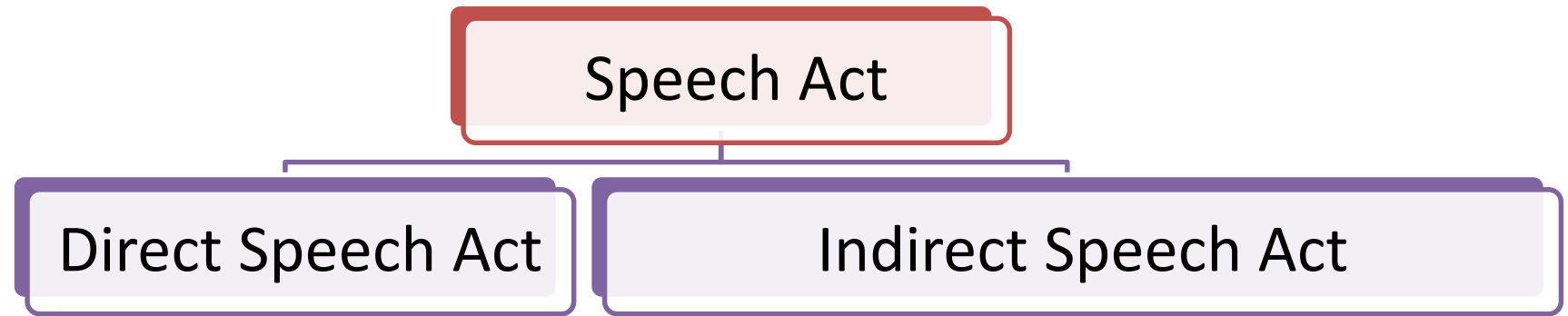
| Statement                                                                           | Pre-supposition                                                                   |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| His wife is waiting outside.                                                        | He is married.                                                                    |
| Why did you arrive late?                                                            | You did arrive late.                                                              |
| How far were you from the gas station, George, when that old thing ran out of fuel? | 1. George was driving.<br>2. He did run out of fuel.<br>3. He has an old vehicle. |

# Pragmatics of Speech: Speech Acts

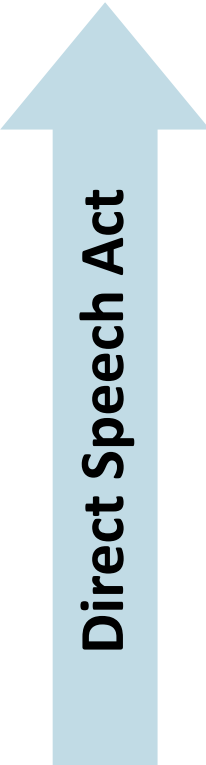
- ❑ **Speech act** is defined as **the action** (for example – requesting, questioning, informing, commanding, promising) **performed by the speaker with an utterance**.

For e.g. – when a speaker says “*I’ll visit you tomorrow at six*”, he is not merely speaking, but also **performing the speech act of ‘promising’**.

- ❑ For a proficient communication of the intended message, it is imperative for the audience to possess knowledge/awareness about **how the speaker intends them to interpret the function of his utterance**.
- ❑ Thus, an **understanding of the speaker’s speech acts** happens to be one of the pre-requisite conversational etiquettes on the part of the audience.
- ❑ Speech acts can be distinguished into:



# Pragmatics of Speech: Direct and Indirect Speech Acts



## Direct Speech Act

An action in which the syntactical form used (e.g. interrogative) is congruent to the function (question) performed by a speaker with an utterance.

E.g. **Did you eat the apple?** (Structure – Interrogative; Function – Question)

**Eat the apple.** (Structure – Imperative; Function – Command)

**You ate the apple.** (Structure – Declarative; Function – Statement)

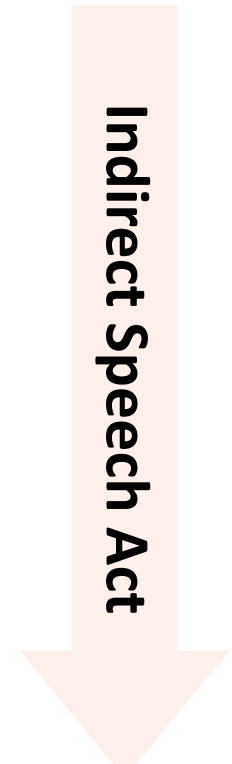
Direct speech acts are more curt and direct in manner.

An action in which the syntactical form used does not directly match with the function performed by the speaker with an utterance.

E.g. **Can you pass me the plate?**  
(Structure – Interrogative; Function – Request)

**You left the window open.** (Structure – Declarative; Function – to make a request to close the window)

Indirect speech acts are considered to be more polite than direct speech acts.



## Indirect Speech Act

# Pragmatics of Speech: Politeness

- ❑ In terms of speech pragmatics, **politeness** can be understood as **showing awareness and consideration of another person's *face***.
- **Face**, in pragmatics of speech, refers to your **public self-image**. It connotes the emotional and social sense of self that a person has and expects others to recognize.

| <i>Face-saving Act</i>                                                                                    | <i>Face-threatening Act</i>                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When the speaker threatens the listener's self-image by exhibiting social power through his/her utterance | When the speaker employs indirect speech act to remove the assumption of social power in his/her utterance               |
| E.g. – “ <b>Give me that bottle!</b> ” (Command)<br>Communicates power over the listener                  | E.g. – “ <b>Could you please pass me that bottle?</b> ” (Request); Reduces the possible threat to listener's <i>face</i> |

- The **markers of politeness differ across cultures**. For instance, in cultures which value straight-forwardness, direct speech acts are considered better expressions.
- In cultures which are disposed to avoiding impositions, indirect speech act is preferred and direct speech acts are considered to be impolite.

# The Co-operative Principle

- ❑ The **co-operative principle** is a general description of the expectations that the interlocutors have in a conversation. This **principle, along with its four maxims**, was propounded by the **philosopher Herbert Paul Grice** as follows:
  - *“Make your conversational contribution such as is required, at the stage at which it occurs, by the accepted purpose or direction of the talk exchange in which you are engaged” (Grice, 1975: 45).*
- ❑ The **four maxims** supporting this principle, referred to as **Gricean Maxims** are:
  - **The Quantity Maxim:** Make your contribution as informative as is required, neither more nor less than is required.
  - **The Quality Maxim:** Do not state that which you believe to be false or for which you lack adequate evidence.
  - **The Relation Maxim:** Be relevant.
  - **The Manner Maxim:** Be clear, brief and orderly.



# Speech Etiquettes: Use of Hedges

- ❑ **Hedges** refer to a word or a phrase that is employed to indicate that the speaker is not completely sure that his/her utterance is sufficiently correct or complete.
- ❑ The need of the use of hedges entails from **adherence to the co-operative principle**, and is, thus, a **pre-requisite of speech etiquettes**.
- ❑ A few **examples of hedges** used in sentences include:
  - So, **to cut a long story short**, we managed to get our stuffs back from the thief. (The speaker is conscious of the **Quantity Maxim**.)
  - **I'm not absolute sure**, but I think the meeting is scheduled on Friday evening. (The speaker is conscious of the **Quality Maxim**.)
  - **Not to change the subject**, but whose hand writing is this? (The speaker is conscious of the **Relation Maxim**.)
  - **I don't know if this is clear at all**, but I think the car had no lights and it crashed while it was reversing. (The speaker is conscious of the **Manner Maxim**.)

# Speech Etiquettes: Implicatures

- ❑ George Yule defines implicature in speech as “**an additional meaning (other than the literal sense of a statement) conveyed by a speaker adhering to the co-operative principle**”.
- ❑ To arrive at a meaningful interpretation of implicatures in a conversation involves an **appeal to some background knowledge** to be shared by the conversational participants.
- ❑ The use of implicatures involves **paying careful attention to the maxims of co-operative Principle**.

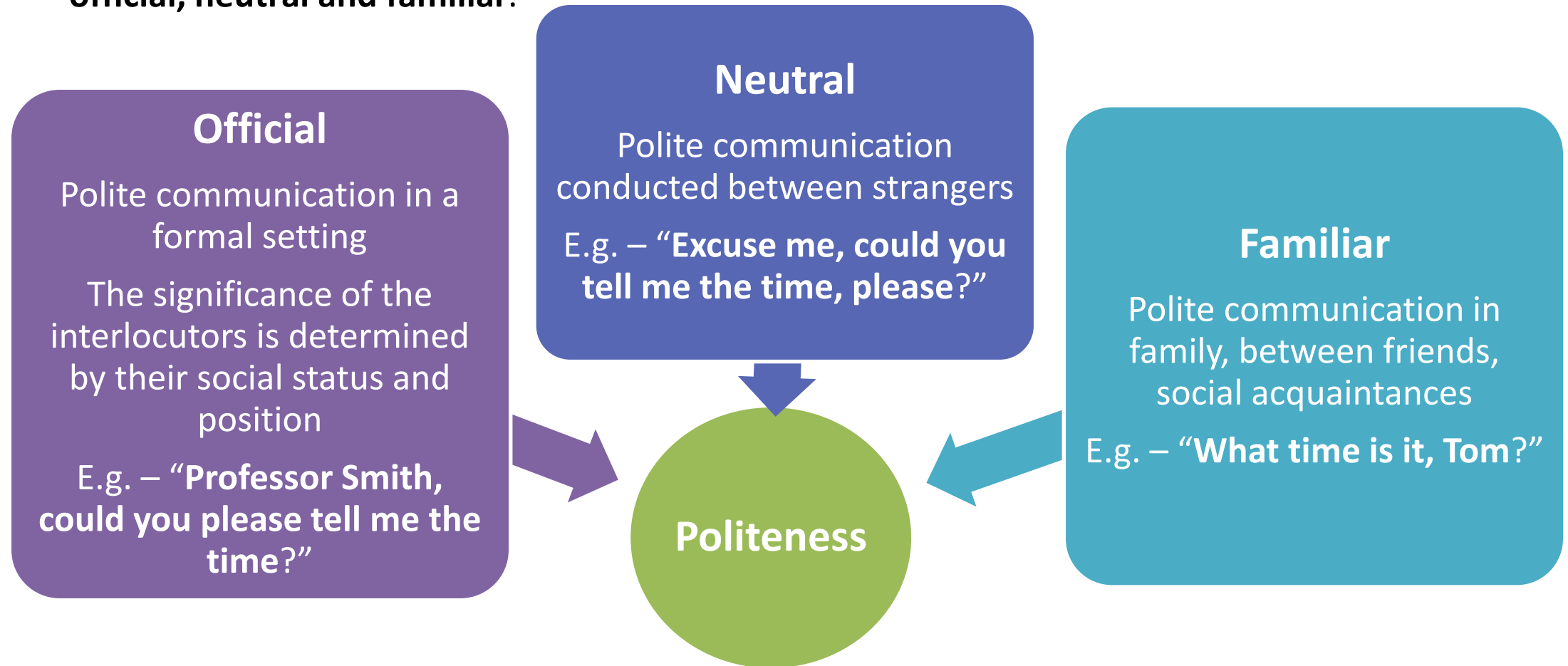
Peter: Lucy,  
would you join us  
for the movie,  
tonight?

Lucy: I have an  
exam tomorrow.

Lucy's statement is not a direct answer to Peter's question. But, Peter, through his **background knowledge** will understand that “**exam tomorrow**” means “**study tonight**” which further rules out the possibility of “**movie tonight**”. Thus, Lucy statement about tomorrow's activities **contains an implicature** concerning tonight's plan.

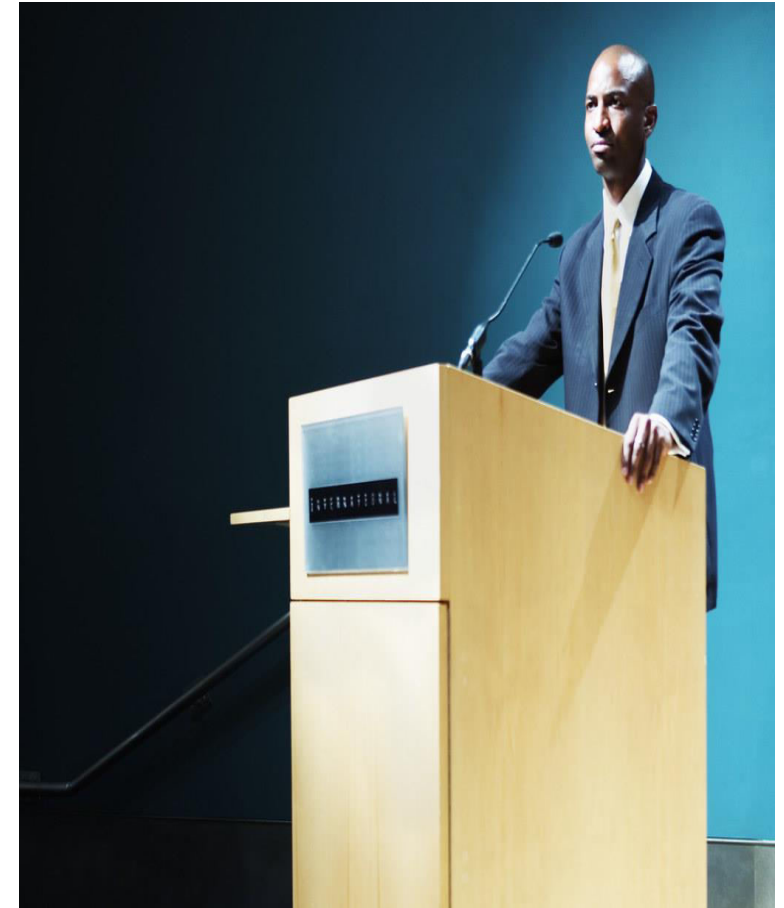
# Contextual Variations of Speech Etiquettes

- The **three levels of politeness in communication** correspond to their own **style of speech** – **official, neutral and familiar**.



# Etiquettes on the Podium

- ✓ **Stand at a proper distance from the lectern:** Stand 10 to 12 inches behind the lectern. Don't lean upon the lectern. Do not beat or pound on the lectern to emphasize your point.
- ✓ **Do not leave the podium unattended:** After finishing the speech, the speaker should wait patiently at the lectern until the host takes charge of it. Also, do not pace upon the stage without purpose while delivering your talk.
- ✓ **Introducing a speaker:** The host should stay at the podium and greet the speaker (by a professional handshake) before leaving stage to the speaker. The speaker, in turn, should begin the speech by thanking the host for introducing him/her.
- ✓ **Leave the lectern gracefully:** Do not end your presentation by gathering up your script papers while leaving the podium. Rather, enjoy the applause of the audience and leave gracefully. The notes and props can be collected after the meeting has ended.



# Etiquettes for Telephonic Conversation

## **PHONE**

### **BE AWARE OF YOUR SPEAKING VOLUME.**

Some people just don't know how loud they are, especially when their attention is focused on the person on the other line.

### **DON'T ANSWER YOUR PHONE WHEN MEETING WITH OTHERS.**

If you answer a call, you're basically telling the person you're meeting that someone else is more deserving of your time than they are.

### **DON'T PLACE YOUR PHONE ON THE TABLE WHEN MEETING OTHERS.**

Otherwise, it looks like you're ready to drop them and connect with someone else.

### **LET THE OTHER PERSON KNOW WHEN YOU HAVE THEM ON SPEAKERPHONE.**

If you must put someone on speakerphone, make sure you immediately let them know who else is in the room with you.





- ❖ Netiquette, an abbreviation for network etiquette, refers to a set of guidelines prescribed for appropriate social interaction and courteous communication in the online environment.

- ❖ Share Cautiously - Do not give out personal credentials and passwords
- ❖ Use polite language – Avoid “Hate Speech” and offensive comments under posts and photos.
- ❖ Observe others' bandwidth and privacy – esp. while uploading and sharing photos and videos.
- ❖ Verify the details before posting
- ❖ Watch out for identity theft.

Netiquette  
:) ;)

:P \* < | :) !



# Etiquette for conferencing tools



## Headset

Background noise can get in the way, wearing a headset can eliminate interruptions and help students hear you clearly



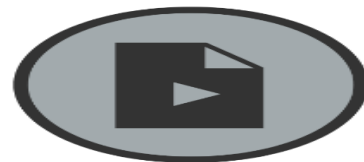
## Mute

Mute yourself when you're not speaking and ask students to do the same. This reduces background noise for everyone in the session



## Webcam

Share your webcam so students can see you. This helps to establish your presence and allows students to see your expressions and gestures when speaking



## Record

Recording your session allows students who are not present the ability to view the session, and provides an opportunity for all students to watch and reflect on the session's content



## Set-up

Connect a few minutes early so you can set up and feel prepared to start on time. Just like in face to face classes, some students will arrive early



## Scan

Scan your work area, what is in the webcam frame that students will see? Some tools will allow for virtual backgrounds, but not all do, so be aware of your personal surroundings

# Homilies on Etiquettes of speech

*“Words that do not cause distress, are truthful, inoffensive, and beneficial, as well as regular recitation of the Vedic scriptures – these are declared as austerity of speech.”*

– Bhagavad Gita: Chapter 7, Verse 15

*“Talk straight, to the point, without any ambiguity or deception.”* Holy Quran [33:70]

*“Always speak the truth. Shun words that are deceitful and ostentatious.”* Holy Quran [22:30]

*“Speak in a civilized manner in a language that is recognized by the society and is commonly used.”* Holy Quran [4:5]

*“Let no corrupting talk come out of your mouths, but only such as is good for building up, as fits the occasion, that it may give grace to those who hear.”* – Holy Bible – Ephesians 4:29

*“Whoever guards his mouth preserves his life; he who opens wide his lips comes to ruin.”*

– Holy Bible – Proverbs 13:3

According to Buddhist teachings, **Right Speech** or *samma vaca* is described as: *“Abstaining from lying, from divisive speech, from abusive speech, & from idle chatter: this is called right speech.”* – Samyutta Nikaya XLV.8



# Etiquettes of Speech: Statistics

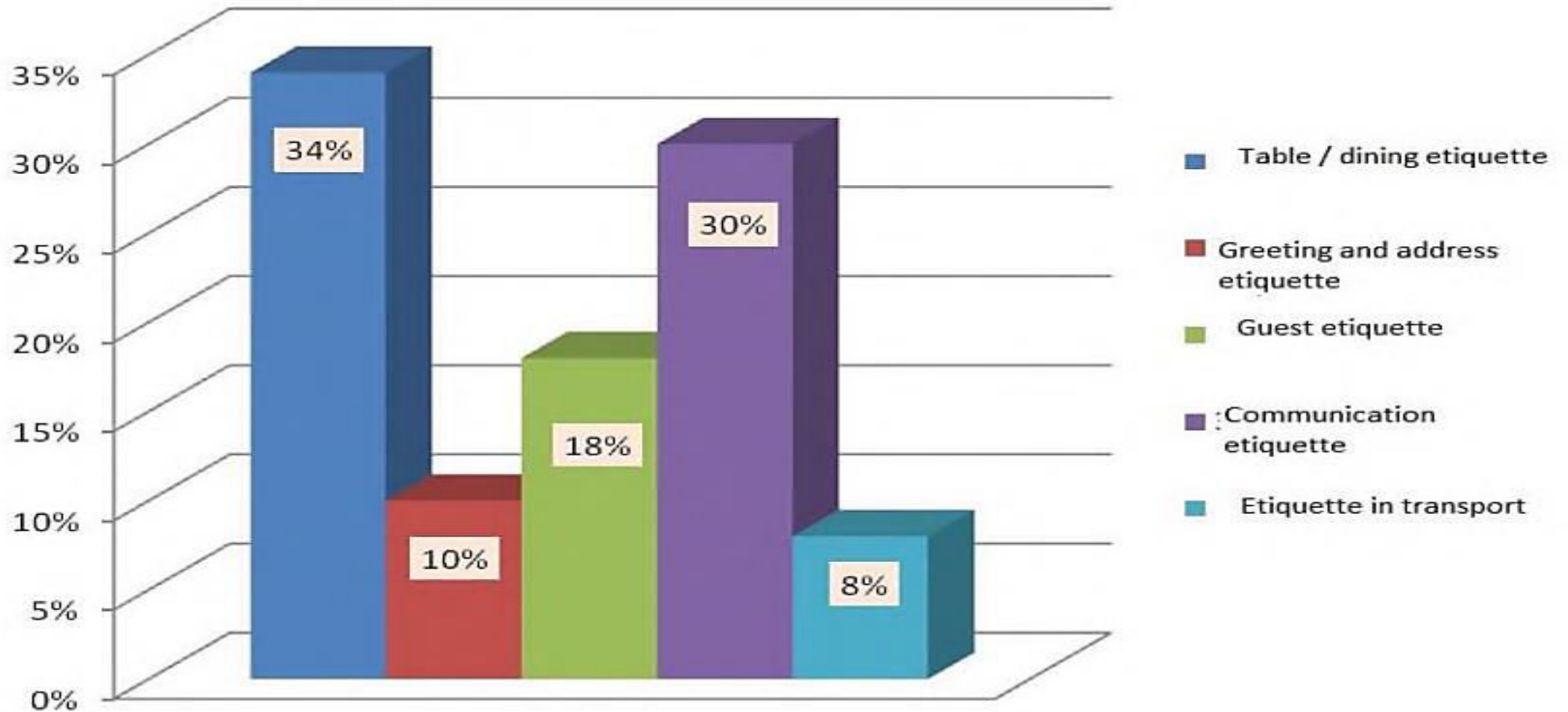


Fig. The Ratio of Types of Etiquettes

good manners  
will often take  
people where  
neither money  
nor education  
will take them

**Thank You**

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